

# Prices Held. The Clock Didn't.

Maryland Market Intelligence | Week of September 14-20, 2026

Kyle Friedman | The Friedman Team at eXp Realty | Numbers Over Guesswork

*A hyperlocal, data-driven weekly Maryland market report.*

## The Story of the Week

Denise and Walt listed their Frederick County house on Monday, September 14th.

Their agent had run the comps and suggested \$525,000. Walt wanted \$549,900. "We can always come down," he said, and Denise, who had sold a house once before, agreed to try it. Prices were holding. Nothing in the headlines said otherwise.

By Thursday there had been eleven showings and no offers. That same day, Freddie Mac announced the 30-year mortgage rate had jumped to 6.95%, up 19 basis points in a single week and the fourth increase in a row. On a \$400,000 loan, that is about \$51 more a month than the week before, and \$77 more than three weeks ago. Every buyer who had toured their house was quietly running that math.

Here is what Denise and Walt could not see from their kitchen table. Across Maryland, the typical home that closed this week had taken 25 days to go under contract, up from 20 the week before. The price side of the market barely flinched: the median sold price rose 1.1% to \$449,900. But buyers took a little more off the original asking price, paying 98.4% of it, down from 99.6%. Price held. Time and negotiating room were what gave.

Their agent saw it in the data, and on Friday morning made the call. Denise and Walt trusted the numbers and dropped to \$529,900, still well above the first comps. Two showings came in that weekend. By Sunday night, they had one offer in hand, and a second buyer was coming back for another look on Monday.

They are not done yet, but they are in a very different place than they were on Thursday. The lesson is simple: a house is only new once, and the sellers who win this market are the ones who read the numbers and move while the window is open.

## Maryland in 60 Seconds

|                                                                |                                                   |                                                   |                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>HOMES SOLD</b><br><b>984</b><br>+39.0%                      | <b>NEW LISTINGS</b><br><b>2,269</b><br>-4.1%      | <b>PENDING</b><br><b>482</b><br>flat +0.2%        | <b>MEDIAN SOLD PRICE</b><br><b>\$449,900</b><br>+1.1% |
| <b>MEDIAN DAYS TO CONTRACT</b><br><b>25 days</b><br>+5 from 20 | <b>PRICE REDUCTIONS</b><br><b>1,786</b><br>-11.2% | <b>30-YR FIXED RATE</b><br><b>6.95%</b><br>+19 bp | <b>FMMI SCORE</b><br><b>44 / 100</b><br>cooling       |

*Median Days to Contract uses this report's weekly Bright MLS pull (median CDOM for Closed sales). Pending Contracts is the sum of all 24 county pulls.*

## What the Numbers Really Mean

**The clock moved more than the price.** The median time to contract for homes that closed this week rose to 25 days from 20, a five-day jump in one week and the largest move this report has tracked since it began measuring it this way in late August. The median sold price went the other way, up 1.1% to \$449,900.

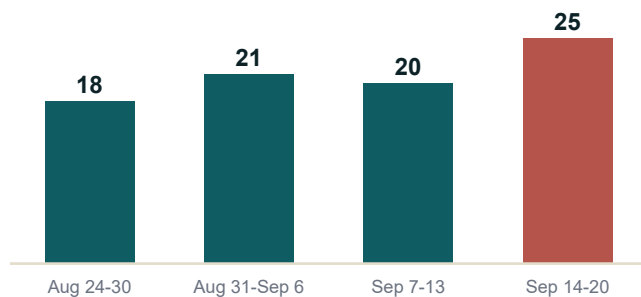
**Sellers are holding the line on price, and cutting less.** Price reductions fell 11.2% to 1,786, and new listings dipped 4.1% to 2,269. The median new-listing price slipped 4.1% to \$429,990, which reads as sellers listing a touch lower to start, not as a market that is falling.

**Buyers found a little more room.** Homes that closed sold for a median 98.4% of their original list price, down from 99.6% a week earlier. But measured against their final list price, the median was still 100.0%, exactly where it was. That means the extra give came from price cuts made before the sale, not from buyers pushing accepted prices down. It is the cost of launching too high. See the Deep Dive below.

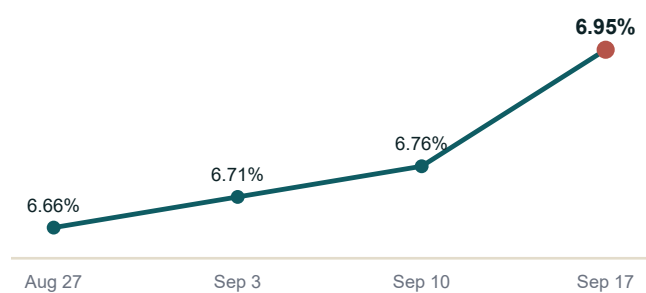
**Closings bounced back, but this is a rebound, not a surge.** Closed sales rose 39.0% to 984 after the Labor Day week, yet that is still 14.4% below the 1,150 closings in the week before the holiday. Pending contracts were flat at 482. Total closed volume was \$533.0 million.

**The rate spike has not shown up in the closed data yet, and that is the thing to watch.** Homes that closed this week were mostly contracts signed weeks ago, before the rate moved from 6.76% to 6.95%. The next two to three weeks of pending contracts are where the rate would show up if it is going to.

Median days to contract (closed sales)

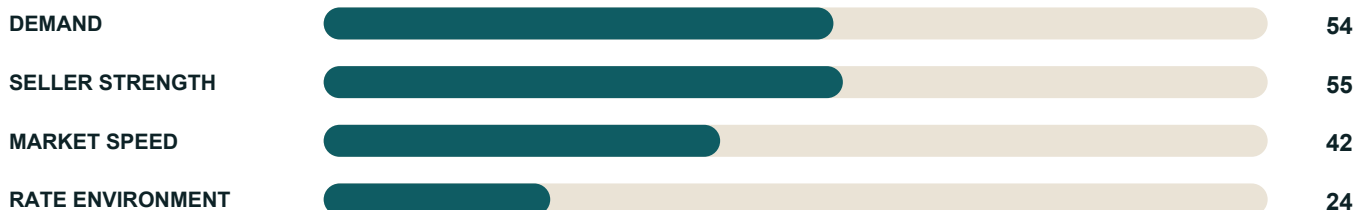


Freddie Mac 30-year fixed rate



## The Friedman Market Momentum Index (FMMI)

44 / 100: Balanced Market, Cooling



**What this means:** The FMMI slipped four points from last week, and the reason is simple. Price and supply held up, while speed and the rate moved the wrong way. Nothing broke. The market cooled at the edges.

- **Demand Score: 54.** Closings rose 39.0% off the holiday week but sit 14.4% below the pre-holiday pace, and pending contracts were flat at 482. A rebound, not a surge.
- **Seller Strength Score: 55.** Median sold price rose 1.1% and price reductions fell 11.2%, offset by the sold-to-original-list ratio slipping to 98.4% and a 4.1% dip in the median new-listing price.
- **Market Speed Score: 42.** Median days to contract stretched from 20 to 25, the biggest weekly slowdown tracked.
- **Rate Environment Score: 24.** The Freddie Mac 30-year fixed rose 19 basis points to 6.95%, its fourth straight weekly increase and by far the steepest of the four.

## The Friedman Signal: Cooling

Maryland's housing market cooled this week, and it did it quietly. Prices held and even ticked up, price cuts fell, and sellers listed a bit more conservatively. What changed is the clock: homes took five more days to go under contract, and buyers took a little more off the original ask. Then Freddie Mac put the mortgage rate at 6.95%, nearly seven, the fourth increase in a row. Closings rebounded from the holiday week, but they are mostly contracts written before the rate moved. Watch the next two or three weeks of pending contracts and days to contract. That is where a rate this high starts to show, if it is going to.

## Market Spotlight: The 11 Biggest Markets

Maryland's 11 largest counties by closings this week made up 83% of the state's sales. Here is how each one moved.

**Montgomery County.** The state's biggest market closed 151 homes at a \$642,215 median, up 2.8% from last week. Homes took longer to sell, a 37-day average versus 25 (the median was 23, so a few long-sitting listings pulled the average up), and sold for a median 98.0% of original list. New listings fell 10.2% to 377, and the new-listing-to-closing ratio eased to 2.5x from 4.5x.

**Anne Arundel County.** 110 closings at a \$532,500 median, up 6.5%, with a 34-day average (median 13) and homes selling at 98.7% of original list. New listings dipped 5.6% to 203, a 1.8x ratio that makes it one of the tighter large markets.

**Prince George's County.** 104 closings at a \$471,995 median. That is up from \$414,000, though last week's figure sat on a thin holiday-week sample of 49 closings. The average days on market improved to 33 from 37, and homes sold at a median 100.0% of original list. New listings held flat at 282, and the supply ratio dropped to 2.7x from 5.7x as closings returned.

**Baltimore County.** 102 closings at a \$381,000 median, up 2.3%, with a 27-day average (median 12), the third-fastest market in the state, and homes selling at 99.8% of original list. It also led the state in pending contracts with 88. New listings rose 10.9% to 275, a 2.7x ratio.

**Baltimore City.** 86 closings at a \$225,500 median, down 4.6%, and a 45-day average. It carries the most supply relative to closings among the large counties, 3.2x, with 276 new listings, down 5.2%. Homes sold at a median 98.7% of original list.

**Frederick County.** 67 closings at a \$527,425 median, up from \$455,000. New listings fell 27.6% to 97, giving Frederick the tightest supply ratio in the state at 1.4x, and homes sold at 99.6% of original list, near the top of the large counties. The average days on market rose to 37 from 29, but the median was 20.

**Howard County.** 51 closings at a \$700,000 median, the highest of any county with a meaningful sample and up from \$595,000 last week. A 26-day average made it the second-fastest market in the state. New listings fell 14.0% to 92, a 1.8x ratio, and homes sold at 98.7% of original list.

**Harford County.** 47 closings at a \$425,000 median, up 9.1%, and the pace snapped back to a 30-day average from 48 last week (median 18). New listings slipped 6.0% to 94 with 33 pending contracts, a 2.0x ratio. Homes sold at 98.3% of original list.

**Worcester County.** 37 closings at a \$464,200 median, down from \$525,000, with a 66-day average (median 44). Worcester had the softest pricing among the big markets: homes sold for a median 95.8% of original list and 97.4% of final list. New listings rose 12.5% to 72, a 1.9x ratio. This is the resort market to watch as the season ends.

**Charles County.** 36 closings at a \$425,000 median, down from \$479,500, with the average days on market stretching to 59 from 35 (median 41). New listings fell 18.4% to 84, a 2.3x ratio, and homes sold at 98.1% of original list.

**Carroll County (Kyle's home county).** 29 closings at a \$360,000 median, down from \$449,000 last week. Medians swing with the mix of homes that close in a small week, and homes here still sold at a median 100.0% of original list, so this looks like a mix of smaller homes closing rather than a price drop. The average was 44 days (median 21). Carroll is also among the tightest markets in the state: 43 new listings, down 21.8%, a 1.5x ratio.

### Three-Week Trend: Median Sold Price and Average Days on Market

| County           | 8/31-9/6            | 9/7-9/13            | 9/14-9/20           |
|------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| Montgomery       | \$647,500 / 30 days | \$625,000 / 25 days | \$642,215 / 37 days |
| Anne Arundel     | \$487,000 / 28 days | \$500,000 / 26 days | \$532,500 / 34 days |
| Prince George's  | \$445,000 / 33 days | \$414,000 / 37 days | \$471,995 / 33 days |
| Baltimore County | \$360,000 / 30 days | \$372,500 / 29 days | \$381,000 / 27 days |
| Baltimore City   | \$265,000 / 45 days | \$236,250 / 41 days | \$225,500 / 45 days |
| Frederick        | \$484,218 / 29 days | \$455,000 / 29 days | \$527,425 / 37 days |
| Harford          | \$395,000 / 25 days | \$389,500 / 48 days | \$425,000 / 30 days |
| Charles          | \$430,000 / 50 days | \$479,500 / 35 days | \$425,000 / 59 days |
| Worcester        | \$461,250 / 56 days | \$525,000 / 51 days | \$464,200 / 66 days |
| Carroll          | \$533,000 / 30 days | \$449,000 / 27 days | \$360,000 / 44 days |

*Medians move with the mix of homes that close in a given week, so treat single-week swings in the smaller counties as directional, not as a trend.*

## This Week's Price Extremes

**Highest-priced new listing:** \$9,500,000, in Anne Arundel County. **Lowest-priced new listing:** \$10,000, in Allegany County and Baltimore City. The highest closed sale of the week was \$5,437,500 in Anne Arundel County and the lowest was \$11,000 in Baltimore City.

*These are the statewide extremes from this week's Bright MLS pull rather than featured properties. The very lowest prices are typically auction opening bids or non-standard sales, not typical market prices.*

# Friedman Heat Map: Fastest and Slowest Maryland Counties This Week

## Hottest Markets, Fastest Average Days on Market

| County                 | Avg. DOM | Closings |
|------------------------|----------|----------|
| St. Mary's County      | 21 days  | 17       |
| Howard County          | 26 days  | 51       |
| Baltimore County       | 27 days  | 102      |
| Harford County         | 30 days  | 47       |
| Prince George's County | 33 days  | 104      |

## Cooling Markets, Slowest Average Days on Market

| County           | Avg. DOM | Closings |
|------------------|----------|----------|
| Garrett County   | 102 days | 10       |
| Caroline County  | 98 days  | 10       |
| Cecil County     | 66 days  | 18       |
| Worcester County | 66 days  | 37       |
| Charles County   | 59 days  | 36       |

(Cecil's average is pulled up by a few long-sitting listings; its median is just 13 days. Dorchester posted a 122-day average on only 7 closings, Somerset 71 days on 4, and Kent 12 days on 3, all too small to read as trends. Carroll County, Kyle's home county, came in at a 44-day average on 29 closings, with a median of 21.)

## Where the New Supply Is Landing: County-by-County Pressure

The ratio below is new listings this week divided by closings this week. A higher number means supply is growing faster than the market is absorbing it (more room for buyers to negotiate), a lower number means new supply is barely keeping pace with demand (tighter for buyers). Statewide it was 2.3x, down from 3.3x last week, mostly because closings rebounded from the holiday.

### Supply building fastest (new listings far outpacing closings):

| County                 | New Listings | Closed | Ratio |
|------------------------|--------------|--------|-------|
| Baltimore City         | 276          | 86     | 3.2x  |
| Wicomico County        | 32           | 10     | 3.2x  |
| Prince George's County | 282          | 104    | 2.7x  |
| Baltimore County       | 275          | 102    | 2.7x  |
| Washington County      | 68           | 27     | 2.5x  |

### Tightest counties (new supply barely ahead of closings):

| County           | New Listings | Closed | Ratio |
|------------------|--------------|--------|-------|
| Frederick County | 97           | 67     | 1.4x  |
| Talbot County    | 22           | 15     | 1.5x  |
| Carroll County   | 43           | 29     | 1.5x  |

| County          | New Listings | Closed | Ratio |
|-----------------|--------------|--------|-------|
| Garrett County  | 17           | 10     | 1.7x  |
| Caroline County | 18           | 10     | 1.8x  |

Last week's leaders, Prince George's at 5.7x, Baltimore City at 4.7x and Montgomery at 4.5x, all came down sharply. That is the holiday distortion unwinding. Baltimore City and Baltimore County now carry the most supply relative to sales among the big counties, while Frederick, Talbot and Carroll remain the tightest.

## Week Over Week: How Maryland's Housing Market Compares

| Metric                         | Last Week (9/7-9/13) | This Week (9/14-9/20) | Change            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|
| Closed Sales (Statewide)       | 708                  | 984                   | +276 (+39.0%)     |
| New Listings                   | 2,366                | 2,269                 | -97 (-4.1%)       |
| Pending Contracts              | 481                  | 482                   | +1 (+0.2%)        |
| Price Reductions               | 2,011                | 1,786                 | -225 (-11.2%)     |
| Median Sold Price              | \$445,000            | \$449,900             | +\$4,900 (+1.1%)  |
| Median New-Listing Price       | \$448,383            | \$429,990             | -\$18,393 (-4.1%) |
| Days to Contract (Closed CDOM) | 20                   | 25                    | +5 days           |
| Sold-to-Original-List (median) | 99.6%                | 98.4%                 | -1.2 points       |
| 30-Year Mortgage Rate          | 6.76%                | 6.95%                 | +19 basis points  |

The headline: prices and volume held together while time and negotiating room moved. The market is cooling at the edges as fall settles in, not breaking.

## Winners and Losers This Week

### Winners

- **Sellers who priced right on day one:** the median home still sold for 100.0% of its final list price, and price reductions fell 11.2%
- **Frederick County:** the tightest supply in Maryland at 1.4x, with a \$527,425 median and 99.6% of original list
- **Howard County:** a \$700,000 median and a 26-day average, the second fastest market in the state
- **St. Mary's County:** the fastest market in Maryland, a 21-day average on 17 closings

### Losing Momentum

- **Days to contract:** 20 to 25, the biggest weekly slowdown this report has tracked
- **Rate-sensitive buyers:** 6.76% to 6.95%, the fourth straight increase and by far the steepest of the four
- **Garrett County:** a 102-day average on market, the slowest of any county with a meaningful sample
- **Worcester County:** homes sold at a median 95.8% of original list price, the softest of the big counties

## One Thing I'd Do This Week

**If I were buying a home in Maryland:** Lock your rate. It rose 19 basis points this week, which is about \$51 more a month on a \$400,000 loan, and it has now risen four weeks running. The upside is that buyers are getting a little more room: homes sold at 98.4% of original list, and with 2,269 new listings there is inventory to choose from. Spend that leverage on price and terms, not on waiting for a better rate.

**If I were selling a home in Maryland:** Price for week one. The typical home took 25 days to go under contract this week, five more than last week, and the gap between what sellers first asked and what they got widened to 1.6 points. Homes priced right on day one are still selling at full final list price. The ones that launch high pay for it in time.

**If I were investing in Maryland real estate:** Look where the clock is slowest and the pricing is softest. Garrett (102 days) and Caroline (98 days) are moving slowest, and Worcester sold at 95.8% of original list, which is where motivated sellers and real negotiating room live right now. On the supply side, Baltimore City and Wicomico carry the most inventory relative to closings at 3.2x each.

## Deep Dive: The Number That Explains This Week

### 1.6 points

That is the gap between what sellers first asked and what they finally got for the typical Maryland home that closed this week: 98.4% of the original list price, versus 100.0% of the final list price. Last week that gap was 0.4 points. It quadrupled in seven days.

Here is why it matters. Sellers did not lose ground at the closing table. The median home still sold for exactly its final list price, the same as last week. What changed is how many sellers had to get there by cutting. The 1.6 points is the price they gave up between launching and settling, and on a \$450,000 home it is about \$7,200, compared with about \$1,800 last week.

The 1.6 points is only half the cost. The other half is time: 25 days to go under contract instead of 20. A price cut needs days to work its way through buyers, and this week the typical wait for a contract got longer. The cheapest price cut is the one you never have to make.

## Bonus From My Kitchen: Apple Cider Pork Chops

Maryland apple season is in full swing, from the orchards in Carroll and Frederick counties to the farm stands along the Shore. This is a one-skillet dinner that leans on exactly what is in season, and it comes together in about 35 minutes.

### Serves 4

- 4 bone-in pork chops, about 1 inch thick
- 1 teaspoon salt and 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 medium yellow onion, sliced
- 2 firm apples (Honeycrisp or Stayman Winesap), cored and cut into 8 wedges each
- 1 cup unfiltered apple cider
- 1 tablespoon Dijon mustard
- 1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar

- 4 sprigs fresh thyme (or 1 teaspoon dried)
  - 1 tablespoon butter
- 1 Pat the chops dry and season both sides with the salt and pepper.
  - 2 Heat the oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Sear the chops about 4 minutes per side until golden, then move them to a plate.
  - 3 Lower the heat to medium. Cook the onion for 4 minutes, then add the apples and cook 3 minutes more.
  - 4 Pour in the cider, mustard, vinegar, and thyme, scraping up the browned bits, and simmer 3 minutes.
  - 5 Nestle the chops back in, cover, and cook on low 8 to 10 minutes, until the center reaches 145 degrees F. Let them rest 3 minutes.
  - 6 Stir the butter into the pan sauce and spoon the apples, onions, and sauce over the chops.

Serve with mashed potatoes or roasted sweet potatoes and a bitter green salad to balance the sweetness.

## Your Next Move Starts Here

Whether you're thinking about selling or searching for your next home, the right information makes all the difference.

**Check Your Home's Value:** Receive a personalized home value estimate based on recent comparable sales, current market trends, and local buyer demand, not just an automated online estimate.

**Search Homes for Sale:** Browse the latest listings with real time MLS updates, save your favorite properties, and receive instant alerts when new homes hit the market.

## Let's Talk

Ready to get started? Kyle Friedman with The Friedman Team at eXp Realty is ready to go to work for you.

### Kyle Friedman

Licensed Realtor | Expert Negotiator

Owner, Founder / The Friedman Team at eXp Realty

Phone 443-789-3101 | Office 888-860-7369

Email [kyle@friedmanreteam.com](mailto:kyle@friedmanreteam.com)

8115 Maple Lawn Blvd, Suite 350, Fulton, MD 20759

### Why Choose Kyle?

- 80% more views than comparable listings
- 5,000+ calls a month to find your buyer
- Cinematic video and best in class photography
- Zillow Showcase premium placement
- Investor mindset on every deal since 2018

Equal Housing Opportunity. Kyle Friedman is a licensed real estate agent.

Data source: Bright MLS, week of September 14-20, 2026. Mortgage rate:

Freddie Mac PMMS, released September 17, 2026.

## Full County-by-County Data Table (all 24 jurisdictions)

| County           | New Listings | Median New-List Price | Pending    | Closed     | Median Sold Price | Avg. DOM | New:Closed Ratio |
|------------------|--------------|-----------------------|------------|------------|-------------------|----------|------------------|
| Allegany         | 29           | \$150,000             | 4          | 9          | \$125,000         | 35       | 3.2x             |
| Anne Arundel     | 203          | \$512,900             | 50         | 110        | \$532,500         | 34       | 1.8x             |
| Baltimore City   | 276          | \$245,000             | 58         | 86         | \$225,500         | 45       | 3.2x             |
| Baltimore County | 275          | \$377,545             | 88         | 102        | \$381,000         | 27       | 2.7x             |
| Calvert          | 49           | \$499,000             | 6          | 22         | \$487,450         | 40       | 2.2x             |
| Caroline         | 18           | \$323,900             | 2          | 10         | \$287,495         | 98       | 1.8x             |
| Carroll          | 43           | \$474,550             | 20         | 29         | \$360,000         | 44       | 1.5x             |
| Cecil            | 33           | \$388,000             | 11         | 18         | \$375,000         | 66       | 1.8x             |
| Charles          | 84           | \$472,000             | 9          | 36         | \$425,000         | 59       | 2.3x             |
| Dorchester       | 20           | \$360,000             | 3          | 7          | \$299,999         | 122      | 2.9x             |
| Frederick        | 97           | \$499,900             | 21         | 67         | \$527,425         | 37       | 1.4x             |
| Garrett          | 17           | \$429,900             | 2          | 10         | \$393,750         | 102      | 1.7x             |
| Harford          | 94           | \$423,850             | 33         | 47         | \$425,000         | 30       | 2.0x             |
| Howard           | 92           | \$534,490             | 31         | 51         | \$700,000         | 26       | 1.8x             |
| Kent             | 12           | \$409,450             | 1          | 3          | \$332,000         | 12       | 4.0x             |
| Montgomery       | 377          | \$644,500             | 50         | 151        | \$642,215         | 37       | 2.5x             |
| Prince George's  | 282          | \$439,450             | 49         | 104        | \$471,995         | 33       | 2.7x             |
| Queen Anne's     | 24           | \$577,450             | 5          | 12         | \$455,000         | 46       | 2.0x             |
| Somerset         | 12           | \$250,000             | 4          | 4          | \$242,450         | 71       | 3.0x             |
| St. Mary's       | 40           | \$422,450             | 4          | 17         | \$470,000         | 21       | 2.4x             |
| Talbot           | 22           | \$567,000             | 5          | 15         | \$680,000         | 57       | 1.5x             |
| Washington       | 68           | \$382,500             | 15         | 27         | \$360,000         | 34       | 2.5x             |
| Wicomico         | 32           | \$344,900             | 6          | 10         | \$375,250         | 57       | 3.2x             |
| Worcester        | 72           | \$392,000             | 5          | 37         | \$464,200         | 66       | 1.9x             |
| <b>Statewide</b> | <b>2,269</b> | <b>\$429,990</b>      | <b>482</b> | <b>984</b> | <b>\$449,900</b>  | n/a      | <b>2.3x</b>      |

*Pending Contracts by county are the counts of listings that went Pending that week. Statewide Pending is their sum. New:Closed is new listings divided by closings. Counties with under 10 closings are small samples.*